STRATIVA CONSULTING

CORPORATE POLICY & ETHICS MANUAL

Smart Strategies. Sustainable Growth.

Professional Communication Ethics SOP

Document ID:	STR-HR-SOP-006
Version:	1.0 (Final Approved)
Effective Date:	1 January 2027
Prepared By:	Strativa Consulting Management
Approved By:	Managing Director / Founder
Location / Scope:	Karachi Office & Remote Operations

CONFIDENTIAL & PROPRIETARY — STRATIVA CONSULTING HEADQUARTERS

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1. INTRODUCTION AND PURPOSE

Strativa Consulting is committed to maintaining a professional, ethical, respectful, and high-performance work environment. Effective communication is the bedrock of our business consulting, startup development, branding, and digital marketing services. This Professional Communication Ethics Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) establishes clear standards to ensure that all internal and external interactions reflect our core brand values: *Smart Strategies. Sustainable Growth.* [cite: 7]

Clear and ethical communication fosters workplace productivity, strengthens teamwork, guarantees client satisfaction, protects confidential data, and upholds Strativa Consulting's reputation in the Karachi business community and beyond [cite: 7].

2. SCOPE AND APPLICABILITY

This SOP applies universally to all individuals operating on behalf of Strativa Consulting, including full-time and part-time employees, executive management, independent consultants, interns, research fellows, and authorized third-party representatives [cite: 7].

This policy governs all forms of professional interaction, regardless of medium, including in-person meetings, telephone conversations, official email correspondence, online video conferences, instant messaging applications, and social media platforms used for professional purposes [cite: 7].

3. GENERAL COMMUNICATION PRINCIPLES

All personnel at Strativa Consulting must adhere to core communication principles in every professional exchange [cite: 8]:

- **Respectful Language:** Communicate with colleagues, clients, and vendors using polite, courteous, and professional language [cite: 8].
- **Honesty & Clarity:** Ensure all project data, client deliverables, and business reports are truthful, verifiable, and clearly stated [cite: 8].
- **Appropriate Tone:** Adopt a tone that is encouraging, collaborative, and appropriate for business advisory contexts [cite: 8].
- **Cultural Sensitivity:** Demonstrate cultural sensitivity and inclusion, embracing diversity across clients and team members in Karachi and global markets [cite: 8].
- **Active Listening:** Practice active listening during meetings and provide constructive feedback focused on work outputs rather than personalities [cite: 8].
- **No Gossip or Insults:** Strictly prohibit workplace rumors, gossip, personal insults, derogatory remarks, and misleading statements [cite: 8].

- **Respect for Diversity:** Value diverse professional opinions and backgrounds, fostering an environment where innovative startup ideas can thrive [cite: 8].

4. OFFICIAL EMAIL ETIQUETTE AND STANDARDS

Email is a primary formal communication channel for Strativa Consulting. All business correspondence must maintain high standards of professionalism [cite: 8].

- **Corporate Addresses:** All official communications must be sent using assigned corporate email addresses ending in `@strativa.pk`. Personal email accounts must never be used for client deliverables [cite: 8].
- **Standard Signatures:** Every email must include a professional signature containing the sender's full name, designation, company name, tagline, and contact number [cite: 8].
- **Clear Subject Lines:** Subject lines must be concise, descriptive, and indicative of the email content (e.g., 'Project Proposal Review: AZ Signature - Strativa Consulting') [cite: 8].
- **Greetings & Closings:** Begin emails with appropriate formal greetings (e.g., 'Dear Mr. Khan,' or 'Dear Client Team,') and close professionally (e.g., 'Best regards, [Name]') [cite: 8].
- **Concise Formatting:** Keep messages structured, concise, and easy to read by utilizing bullet points for key recommendations or action items [cite: 8].
- **Grammar & Spelling:** Always run grammar and spell-check tools before hitting send to maintain executive presentation standards [cite: 8].
- **CC and BCC Usage:** Use CC (Carbon Copy) only for individuals who need to be informed, and BCC (Blind Carbon Copy) when protecting recipient privacy in external group emails [cite: 8].
- **Secure Attachments:** Check recipient addresses carefully before sending confidential attachments; use encrypted or secure cloud links for sensitive files [cite: 8].
- **No Unnecessary Reply All:** Avoid unnecessary 'Reply All' responses to large distribution lists; reply directly to the sender unless input is required from all participants [cite: 8].
- **Email Documentation:** All significant client discussions, strategic decisions, and proposal changes must be archived in project folders for audit trails [cite: 8].

4.1 Examples of Professional vs. Unprofessional Email Behavior

Professional Email Behavior (Compliant) [cite: 8]	Unprofessional Email Behavior (Prohibited) [cite: 8]
Sending a well-structured email with a clear subject line, polite greeting, verified attachment, and formal corporate signature [cite: 8].	Sending emails from a personal Gmail account with slang, all-caps text, missing attachments, and no signature [cite: 8].
Replying selectively to the project lead while keeping team members informed via CC only when necessary [cite: 8].	Hitting 'Reply All' on a 30-person thread with a personal comment or emoji reaction [cite: 8].
Addressing client feedback constructively: 'Thank you for your review. We have updated the financial model as requested' [cite: 8].	Responding defensively: 'You already saw this draft last week, why are you asking again?' [cite: 8].

5. TELEPHONE AND VOICE CALL ETIQUETTE

Voice communications represent Strativa Consulting directly to clients and external stakeholders [cite: 8].

- **Professional Answering:** Answer calls promptly within three rings with a professional greeting: 'Good morning/afternoon, Strativa Consulting, [Your Name] speaking. How may I assist you?' [cite: 8]
- **Clear Speech:** Speak clearly, at a moderate pace, maintaining an articulate, courteous, and helpful tone [cite: 8].
- **Holding Etiquette:** Always ask for permission and wait for confirmation before placing a caller on hold ('May I place you on a brief hold while I check the file?') [cite: 8].
- **Accurate Messages:** Record accurate messages including caller name, organization, contact number, exact time, and core inquiry details [cite: 8].
- **Returning Calls:** Return all missed client and partner calls within established service windows [cite: 8].
- **Working Hours:** Respect time zones and official working hours (Monday to Saturday, 9:00 AM to 6:00 PM PKT) when placing business calls [cite: 8].
- **Call Confidentiality:** Conduct calls in private, quiet environments to ensure client confidentiality is never breached in public spaces [cite: 8].
- **Handling Complaints:** Handle client complaints with empathy, patience, and professional composure, focusing on prompt solution delivery [cite: 8].

6. PROFESSIONAL MEETING ETIQUETTE

Whether conducted in-person at our Karachi office or via virtual platforms, meetings must be structured and purposeful [cite: 8].

- **Agendas & Scheduling:** Schedule meetings at least 24 hours in advance with a clear agenda, objectives, and required preparation materials [cite: 8].
- **Punctuality:** Join meetings (physical or virtual) on time. Punctuality demonstrates respect for colleagues and clients [cite: 8].
- **Distraction-Free:** Silence mobile phones and eliminate distractions to maintain full engagement [cite: 8].
- **Inclusive Participation:** Ensure all attendees have an opportunity to contribute; encourage open dialogue and diverse viewpoints [cite: 8].
- **Respectful Disagreement:** Disagree respectfully and objectively, focusing on strategic merits rather than personal critique [cite: 8].
- **Minutes of Meetings (MoM):** Designate a meeting scribe to record comprehensive Minutes of Meetings (MoM) capturing key decisions and action items [cite: 8].
- **Action Assignments:** Assign specific responsible persons and strict deadlines to every action item generated during the session [cite: 8].
- **Summary Distribution:** Circulate meeting summaries to all participants within 24 hours following adjournment [cite: 8].

6.1 Sample Meeting Minutes Format

STRATIVA CONSULTING — MEETING MINUTES (MoM) TEMPLATE

Meeting Title: Startup Growth Strategy Review — AZ Signature [cite: 9]

Date & Time: 15 November 2026, 11:00 AM PKT | **Location:** Karachi Office / Zoom [cite: 9]

Attendees: Project Manager, Brand Strategist, Client Representative [cite: 9]

Key Decisions Made: [cite: 9]

1. Approved updated brand positioning framework for Q1 retail launch [cite: 9].
2. Agreed to finalize digital marketing budget by Friday [cite: 9].

Action Items: [cite: 9]

- Finalize brand guidelines deck | **Responsible:** Brand Strategist | **Deadline:** 18 Nov 2026 [cite: 9]
- Review financial projections | **Responsible:** Financial Consultant | **Deadline:** 20 Nov 2026 [cite: 9]

7. MESSAGING AND DIGITAL COMMUNICATION ETIQUETTE

Approved instant messaging platforms (such as Microsoft Teams and official Slack/WhatsApp groups) facilitate agile internal collaboration [cite: 9].

- **Clear Messaging:** Keep messages clear, concise, and directly relevant to project workflows [cite: 9].
- **Professional Tone:** Avoid excessive emojis, internet slang, ALL-CAPS text (interpreted as shouting), and repeated rapid-fire messaging [cite: 9].
- **Group Chat Discipline:** Use group chats strictly for professional coordination; maintain appropriate workplace boundaries [cite: 9].
- **After-Hours Restraint:** Refrain from sending non-urgent messages outside standard working hours unless an emergency has been declared [cite: 9].
- **Secure File Sharing:** Share files securely using approved cloud links rather than unencrypted direct transfers [cite: 9].
- **No Unauthorized Sharing:** Never take unauthorized screenshots or forward confidential client messages to external parties [cite: 9].

8. APPROPRIATE LANGUAGE AND PROFESSIONAL TONE

Communication style must adapt dynamically to the recipient. When addressing executive clients, language must be formal, strategic, and polished. When collaborating with internal team members, tone remains supportive, direct, and constructive [cite: 9].

Inappropriate / Blaming Language [cite: 9]	Professional / Constructive Alternative [cite: 9]
You completely missed this deadline, and now our project is delayed [cite: 9].	We noticed this deliverable is past the scheduled deadline. Let's review the remaining tasks to expedite completion [cite: 9].
Your idea won't work in Karachi's market; that's a mistake [cite: 9].	That is an interesting perspective. Let's analyze how local market dynamics might influence this approach [cite: 9].
I don't have time to explain this again, just figure it out [cite: 9].	Let's schedule a brief 10-minute sync to walk through these requirements together [cite: 9].

9. INTERNAL RESPONSE-TIME SERVICE STANDARDS

To maintain operational efficiency, Strativa Consulting establishes the following internal response-time service standards. These are proposed operational targets rather than guaranteed commercial warranties [cite: 9]:

Communication Category [cite: 9]	Proposed Service Standard [cite: 9]	Operational Notes [cite: 9]
Routine Internal Messages	Within 4 hours	During standard working hours (Teams/Slack) [cite: 9].
Internal Emails	Within 1 business day	Unless marked urgent by a project lead [cite: 9].
Client Emails	Within 4–8 business hours	Immediate acknowledgment preferred [cite: 9].
Urgent Operational Issues	Within 1 hour	Escalate via phone or direct call if needed [cite: 9].
Meeting Invitations	Within 24 hours	Respond to confirm availability promptly [cite: 9].
Missed Client Calls	Within 2 business hours	Return call or send professional text message [cite: 9].
After-Hours Messages	Next business morning	Staff are not expected to respond off-hours [cite: 9].

10. CONFIDENTIALITY AND INFORMATION PROTECTION

Strativa Consulting handles highly sensitive client strategies, financial models, startup plans, and proprietary research. Safeguarding this data is a legal and ethical imperative [cite: 9].

- **Comprehensive Protection:** All client data, business plans, financial records, passwords, and contracts must be treated as strictly confidential [cite: 9].
- **Need-to-Know Basis:** Share confidential information exclusively on a need-to-know basis with authorized team members [cite: 9].
- **Recipient Verification:** Always verify recipient email addresses and telephone numbers before transmitting sensitive materials [cite: 9].
- **Approved Storage:** Store files exclusively on approved corporate cloud repositories (e.g., secure company SharePoint/Drive); never store client data on unapproved personal drives [cite: 9].
- **Public Discretion:** Never discuss sensitive client projects in public places such as cafes, elevators, or public transit [cite: 9].
- **Strict Prohibition:** Unauthorized disclosure, forwarding, or publication of company or client data is strictly prohibited and subject to disciplinary action [cite: 9].
- **Immediate Reporting:** Report any accidental data disclosure immediately to the Project Manager or Managing Director [cite: 9].

11. RESPECTFUL COMMUNICATION, ANTI-HARASSMENT, AND INCLUSION

Strativa Consulting maintains a strict zero-tolerance policy toward harassment, bullying, intimidation, threats, discriminatory remarks, humiliation, repeated unwanted contact, and retaliation against individuals raising genuine concerns [cite: 10].

- **Equal Respect:** Every individual is entitled to respectful treatment, regardless of job title, seniority, background, or identity [cite: 10].
- **Constructive Disagreement:** Professional disagreements must focus strictly on work output; personal attacks are strictly forbidden [cite: 10].
- **Professional Boundaries:** Maintain professional boundaries in all workplace interactions, both online and offline [cite: 10].
- **Fair Investigation:** All complaints regarding harassment or misconduct will be handled fairly, objectively, and with strict confidentiality [cite: 10].
- **Anti-Retaliation:** Complainants and witnesses are fully protected against retaliation to the maximum extent permitted by law and policy [cite: 10].

12. CONFLICT RESOLUTION AND ESCALATION PROCEDURES

When communication breakdowns or interpersonal conflicts occur, employees must follow a structured resolution process [cite: 10]:

1. **Calm Identification:** Approach the situation with emotional composure and objectivity [cite: 10].
2. **Direct Discussion:** Discuss the issue respectfully and directly with the person involved, where safe and appropriate [cite: 10].
3. **Focus on Facts:** Focus exclusively on objective facts, project impact, and collaborative solutions rather than personal grievances [cite: 10].
4. **Document Actions:** Document key discussion points and agreed-upon corrective actions in writing [cite: 10].
5. **Managerial Referral:** If unresolved, refer the matter formally to the Project Manager or supervising department lead [cite: 10].
6. **Executive Escalation:** Escalate serious grievances—such as harassment, threats, discrimination, or major confidentiality breaches—directly to the Managing Director [cite: 10].

Note: Employees are never required to confront an individual directly if doing so would be unsafe, intimidating, or inappropriate [cite: 10].

13. REPORTING INAPPROPRIATE COMMUNICATION

Employees who experience or observe communication misconduct must report it promptly to supervisory leadership or the Managing Director [cite: 10].

- **Required Information:** Provide specific factual details, including dates, times, relevant message transcripts, and names of witnesses [cite: 10].
- **Evidence Preservation:** Preserve digital or physical evidence securely without unauthorized distribution [cite: 10].
- **Discreet Review:** Investigations will be conducted discreetly, maintaining confidentiality on a strict need-to-know basis [cite: 10].
- **Corrective Action:** Proven violations will result in appropriate corrective action, ranging from mandatory counseling to formal disciplinary measures [cite: 10].

14. DOCUMENTATION OF DECISIONS AND COMMITMENTS

To prevent misunderstandings and operational delays, all significant decisions, project scope modifications, and client commitments must be formally documented [cite: 10].

- **Formal Recording:** Record commitments via meeting minutes, follow-up confirmation emails, or project management tracking boards [cite: 10].
- **Commitment Parameters:** For major client commitments, document: Decision Description, Responsible Person, Agreed Deadline, Client/Project Name, Approval Status, and Follow-Up Actions [cite: 10].
- **Written Confirmation:** Any verbal agreement altering project scope, pricing, or delivery timelines must be confirmed in writing by an authorized representative within 24 hours [cite: 10].

15. ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

Organizational Role [cite: 10]	Core Communication & Ethics Responsibility [cite: 10]
Managing Director / Founder	Approves communication policies, oversees executive escalation matters, and ensures ethical governance [cite: 10].
Project Manager	Monitors project communications, ensures timely MoM distribution, and resolves operational team conflicts [cite: 10].
Client Relationship Manager	Maintains professional client correspondence, ensures prompt response standards, and safeguards client data [cite: 10].
All Employees & Consultants	Adhere strictly to communication ethics, maintain data confidentiality, and treat colleagues with respect [cite: 10].
Interns & Temporary Staff	Complete communication orientation on day one, follow email/messaging standards, and report concerns promptly [cite: 10].

16. POLICY VIOLATIONS AND CORRECTIVE ACTIONS

Violations of this Professional Communication Ethics SOP are evaluated objectively based on severity, frequency, and intent. Corrective measures are proportionate and fair [cite: 10]:

- **Coaching & Guidance:** Constructive coaching and informal guidance for minor communication oversights [cite: 10].
- **Written Warnings:** Formal written warnings and mandatory communication retraining for repeated infractions [cite: 10].

- **Access Restriction:** Temporary access restrictions to certain communication channels or client accounts where necessary [cite: 10].
- **Disciplinary Action:** Formal disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment or contract, for severe breaches (e.g., harassment, intentional data leakage) [cite: 10].

17. IMPLEMENTATION, TRAINING, AND REVIEW GOVERNANCE

This policy is communicated to all new personnel during onboarding orientation. Annual refresher briefings ensure ongoing alignment. The policy is reviewed annually by management and updated when operational or legal requirements change [cite: 11].

Version [cite: 11]	Effective Date [cite: 11]	Description of Changes [cite: 11]	Prepared By [cite: 11]	Approved By [cite: 11]
1.0	1 Jan 2027	Initial Release - Final Policy Draft [cite: 11]	Management	Managing Director

18. EMPLOYEE ACKNOWLEDGEMENT AND COMMITMENT FORM

Please sign below to confirm that you have received, read, and agreed to adhere to the Strativa Consulting Professional Communication Ethics SOP.

COMMUNICATION ETHICS SOP — EMPLOYEE ACKNOWLEDGMENT DECLARATION

I hereby acknowledge that I have received, read, and understood the Strativa Consulting Professional Communication Ethics Standard Operating Procedure (Document Reference: **STR-HR-SOP-006**, Version 1.0).

I agree to comply with all communication standards, email etiquette rules, confidentiality obligations, and respectful behavior guidelines set forth in this document throughout my tenure.

Employee Full Name: _____

Job Title / Designation: _____

Department / Project: _____

Employee Signature: _____ **Date:** _____

MANAGEMENT / SUPERVISOR ACKNOWLEDGMENT:

Manager's Name: _____

Manager's Signature: _____ **Date Received:** _____